Halo: Bolt Action Rulebook V2.5

Introduction

Welcome to **Halo: Bolt Action**, where the tactical depth of Bolt Action meets the epic universe of Halo. Command forces from the UNSC or Covenant in fast-paced tabletop battles, using infantry, vehicles, and air support to outmaneuver and defeat your opponent.

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List builder/calculator here

Table of Contents

Introduction 1

Requirements to play HBA 1

Types of units 2

- Aircraft 2
- Walkers 5
- Anti-Grav/Hovercraft 7

Damage Value Chart 7

Weapons table 8

Weapons special rules 10

Units special rules 12

Vehicles special rules 15

Rules summary 18

Requirements to play HBA

In order to play HBA you will need:

- Bolt Action V3 Rulebook.
- Order Dice (Or standard D6 dice can be used as substitutes).
- Tokens and Templates.
- D6 Dice.
- A Bag or a similar non-transparent container.
- A Tape Measure (preferably marked in inches).
- Appropriate ***Halo*** Models for your Force.
- A flat Game Surface to act as a battlefield.
- Terrain such as woods, hills or buildings.

Types of Units

Aircraft (Helicopters/VTOLs)

Aircraft are a unique class of vehicles designed to reflect their speed, agility, and airborne capabilities on the battlefield. These rules distinguish them from standard ground vehicles and grant them greater tactical flexibility.

Deployment

Aircraft always begin the game in **Reserve** (Except Breakthrough) and must enter the battlefield using an **Advance or Run order**. Upon doing so, they are considered flying.

Movement

Aircraft use the Advance and Run orders for movement.

Advance: Move up to **24** inches with unlimited pivots.

Run: Move up to **48** inches with unlimited pivots.

Flying Aircraft may **move over any terrain, unit or obstacle without penalty**, simulating their ability to fly above the battlefield. Aircraft must land or end their move in a position where the model/base/stand physically fits and remains stable. They cannot land in impassable terrain.

Airborne and Landed States

An Aircraft becomes airborne when it enters the battlefield using an **Advance or Run order from Reserve**. A flying Aircraft remains airborne (Flying) as long as it receives an Advance, Run, Fire, Rally, or Ambush order.

To **land**, an Aircraft must be given a **Down order**. When this happens, it descends and lands within **9 inches horizontally** in a legal position and may pivot freely. If the **Down** order is the result of a **failed order test**, the Aircraft does not land, unlike other types of Bolt Action vehicles, it simply loses its activation and remains airborne without moving (No reverse), or if already landed, it remains landed.

Once landed, the Aircraft treats **objectives** like other vehicles and remains on the ground until it is issued an **Advance or Run order**, which causes it to **take off** and become airborne (Flying) again. If a **landed** Aircraft receives a Fire, Rally, Ambush or Down order, it remains on the ground.

Players should use a clear method to distinguish between flying and landed states, such as attaching or removing a flight stand, or placing a visual marker.

Line of Sight and Cover

Flying Aircraft are elevated above the battlefield and interact differently with line of sight. They can see and be seen over most battlefield features, including dense terrain. However, **tall terrain** (such as multi-story buildings, high cliffs, or towers) blocks line of sight unless both the observer and the target are **flying** Aircraft. Players should agree before the game which terrain features are considered "**tall**."

Flying Aircraft do not block line of sight and cannot provide cover to any unit. They also ignore line of sight obstructions from ground models. Additionally, when a **flying** Aircraft targets a unit on the ground, it ignores any friendly units in the line of fire. Normally, a unit cannot shoot through another friendly unit it could potentially harm, but this restriction does not apply to **flying** Aircraft.

When a **flying** Aircraft targets a ground unit, the target only receives cover if the intervening element (terrain or unit) is both within **3 inches** of the target and crosses the line of sight between the Aircraft and the target. Otherwise, intervening elements are ignored for cover purposes. This same rule can **optionally** be used for line of sight blocking if players agree.

When a ground unit targets a **flying** Aircraft, the Aircraft does not receive cover from any intervening units or terrain. Ground units may freely fire at a **flying** Aircraft even if friendly or enemy models are directly in the line of fire. This does not prevent the attack and does not risk friendly fire.

Landed Aircraft follow normal vehicle rules for line of sight. They can be seen as normal, may block line of sight to other units, and can provide or benefit from soft and hard cover.

Shooting

Flying Aircraft may fire all of their weapons when issued an Advance or Fire order. They do not gain **point-blank** bonuses when firing, and units firing at them do not benefit from **point-blank** bonuses either.

If an Aircraft is flying, enemy units suffer a **-1 penalty to hit** it unless they have the **Flak** special rule. **AT Guns do not gain the +1 to Hit** vehicles vs flying aircraft. Aircraft are treated as having the same armor value on all facings; attacks **do not gain bonuses for hitting side, rear, or top armor**. **Flying** Aircraft have a special **5+ Evasion save** that negates damage but not Pin markers, similar to cover saves.

Once **landed**, Aircraft may only fire pintle-mounted weapons unless stated otherwise in their profile.

Command Aircraft

Aircraft cannot be designated as Command Vehicles unless specifically stated in their unit profile. Any HQ units transported aboard follow the standard transport rules.

Transport Rules (If passenger capacity)

Units may embark or disembark from an Aircraft only when it is **landed**. Units with the Flight special rule may disembark from a **flying** Aircraft using an Advance or Run order. No units may embark onto a flying Aircraft.

Damage to Passengers

If a **landed Aircraft** is destroyed, the standard transport destruction rules apply (D6 hits, and any survivors dismount at the wreck location).

If a **flying Aircraft** is destroyed, each unit aboard suffers **D3 pin markers**, then the Aircraft **crashes**, and the standard transport destruction rules are applied. If the crash location is not suitable for the Aircraft model to physically land, the wreck is placed in the **closest legal landing position**.

If a **flying Aircraft becomes On Fire**, resolve the fire effect as normal. Once resolved, **all transported units must disembark immediately**.

If a **flying Aircraft would flee** for any reason **or be destroyed** due to accumulated pin markers while carrying passengers, it must immediately **land in the nearest legal position**. It is then considered **abandoned and becomes a wreck**. The crew is removed, and all transported units dismount safely without taking further damage as per the normal rules.

Assaults

Aircraft can't initiate assaults, whether flying or landed. Flying Aircraft are immune to assault. Landed Aircraft may be assaulted using the standard rules for vehicles and transports.

Aircraft Damage Rules

Aircraft use the following vehicle damage tables. However, Aircraft with Damage Value 6+ are destroyed outright when damaged.

SUPERFICIAL DAMAGE RESULTS ON AIRCRAFT

D6	Effect
1, 2, or 3	**Crew Shaken:** Add 1 pin marker and take a morale test. If it fails and the aircraft is flying, the Aircraft must take a Down order and land immediately in the nearest legal position. If it fails and the aircraft is already landed, it cannot perform further actions this turn. Place a Down order die to represent this.
4 or 5	**Engine Damage:** The Aircraft's speed is halved for the remainder of the game. If this result occurs again, add 1 pin marker and take a Down order to land.
6	**System Malfunction:** The Aircraft must land immediately within 9 inches in the nearest legal position. Add 2 pin markers and take a Down order. If already landed, treat this as "On Fire" from the Full Damage Table.

Note: If the Aircraft takes superficial damage and no legal landing position is available, roll on the Full Damage Table instead of the Superficial Damage Table.

FULL DAMAGE RESULTS ON AIRCRAFT TABLE

D6	Effect
1	**Crew Shaken:** Add 1 pin marker. If flying, the Aircraft must take a Down order and land immediately in the nearest legal position. If landed, it cannot perform further actions this turn. Place a Down order die to represent this.
2	**Targeting Failure:** The weapon's targeting system glitches. The affected vehicle suffers a **–1 to hit** penalty on all shooting for the rest of the game. Add 1 pin marker.
3	**On Fire:** Add 2 pin markers. Roll a morale check. If passed, extinguish the fire and take a Down order and land. If failed and the Aircraft is landed, the crew abandons the Aircraft , and it is destroyed. If the Aircraft is flying, treat it like "Destroyed" below.
4, 5 or 6	**Destroyed:** The Aircraft is destroyed and becomes a wreck. If flying, all units within 6 inches horizontally take D3 pin markers from falling debris.

Note: If the Aircraft takes full damage and you get an effect that requires the Aircraft to land while there is no legal landing position available, add +1 to the roll for determining full damage effects.

Walkers

Walkers are a distinct class of vehicles, combining the mobility and resilience of armored vehicles with the tactical versatility of infantry. Their unique locomotion allows them to navigate terrain and engage in close-quarters combat in ways conventional vehicles cannot.

Movement

Walkers use the Advance and Run orders for movement.

When using an **Advance** order, a walker may move up to 9 inches and perform up to two 90-degree pivots during its move. These may be combined into a single 180-degree pivot.

When using a **Run** order, it may move up to 18 inches but it is limited to a single 90-degree pivot during the move.

Walkers can traverse open ground, rough ground, and obstacles. However, they may not enter buildings. On roads, walkers double their movement distances.

Shooting at Walkers

Shooting at walkers follows the standard rules for targeting vehicles. However, walkers are treated as having the same armor value on all facings; attacks do **not** gain bonuses for hitting side, rear, or top armor. If a walker is damaged, roll on the Standard Vehicle Superficial or Full Damage Table as normal. Walkers with Damage Value 6+ are destroyed outright if damaged.

Walker Assaults

By default, fully enclosed **walkers are treated as tanks when performing assaults**, requiring a Run order and resolving impact per standard vehicle rules. **However**, walkers equipped with the **Assault** special rule use a **different set of mechanics**; Assault walkers roll **2** base attacks, plus **1** additional attack per **Fist**. Walkers can **halve** their attacks rounded up to get an extra +1 PEN. Each attack uses a PEN value based on the walker's class:

Walker Class	PEN Value
Scout	+1
Light	+2
Medium	+3
Heavy	+4
Super-Heavy	+5

Walkers with Assault Assaulting Infantry or Artillery

A walker with **Assault** must be issued a **Run order** and move within 1 inch of the target. If starting more than 6" from the target, the enemy may react with a Fire order. If starting within 6", only units on Ambush may react.

Combat is always resolved simultaneously. Units **do not receive** any **defensive bonuses** in this type of combat. Assault walkers can assault units garrisoned in buildings by ending the assault move within 1’ of the building.

Infantry/artillery must roll a **6+** to hit the walker, as **a walker that is assaulting is moving**. The total number of successful hits becomes a bonus modifier to a single **D6 damage roll** against the walker. If the walker takes damage, roll on the Vehicle Damage Table (or destroy it if it has Damage Value 6+ or open topped). If the result is **immobilized**, it must pass a **Morale check** or be destroyed. If the **infantry/artillery** unit **fails to cause any damage** and **suffers casualties**, the entire **unit loses the fight and is destroyed**. Artillery units also lose the gun (no abandoned gun remains). If no damage is dealt by either side, the combat continues in following turns. **If the walker is damaged but survives**, **infantry units may fall back by a D6" regroup move, even if they took casualties**.

Infantry Assaulting Walkers with Assault

This follows the same procedure. Infantry without **Tank Hunters** assaulting a fully enclosed walker must pass a Morale test at **-3**, even if unpinned. Infantry cannot assault a walker that has a **Run order**, unless it is immobilized or forced Down.

To hit:

- **Advance order**: 6+ to hit
- **Down / Immobilized / Unactivated**: 4+ to hit

Once hits are determined, proceed as per close combat resolution above.

Vehicles without Assault Assaulting a Walker of any kind

This is treated as a **ram** using standard vehicle-on-vehicle assault rules.

Walkers with Assault Assaulting Vehicles

A walker with Assault may assault a vehicle using a **Run order**, ending within 1 inch of the target. If the vehicle is unactivated, within firing arc, and the assault starts more than 6" away, it may react with a Fire order.

Attacks are resolved directly as **damage rolls**. Each uses the PEN value for the walker's class and is applied to the target vehicle's front armor. If damaged, resolve as per standard vehicle damage or destroy the target if it is soft-skinned or open topped.

If the vehicle gets an **immobilized** result, it must take a **Morale test or be destroyed**. If it survives the assault, the target receives 1 pin plus 1 pin for each fist the walker possesses and the walker must fall back by a D6" regroup move.

Assaults Between Walkers Both with Assault

When two walkers with the Assault special rule engage each other in close combat, the fight is **resolved as the rules above but with some differences**. Each walker rolls its attacks using its appropriate PEN values. All **damage is resolved at the same time**.

If none are **destroyed** as a result, each walker receives **1 pin marker plus 1 additional pin marker for each Fist** possessed by its opponent. This **combat continues across turns** until one or both walkers are destroyed or forced to route.

Other Rules

Other than the above rules, Walkers use the standard vehicle rules.

Anti-Grav / Hovercraft

Anti-grav vehicles are a class of highly mobile units, hovering close to the ground and using advanced propulsion systems to glide effortlessly over terrain.

Movement

Anti-grav vehicles use the Advance and Run orders for movement.

When given an **Advance** order, an anti-grav vehicle may move up to **9 inches** and perform up to **four 90-degree pivots** during the move. These may be combined into a single pivot of up to **360 degrees**.

With a **Run** order, it may move up to **18 inches** and perform up to **two 90-degree pivots**, which may be combined into a single **180-degree pivot**.

Anti-grav vehicles may traverse **open ground**, **rough ground**, and **obstacles**. They may **not enter buildings or ruins**, and **cannot Run through rough terrain**.

On roads, anti-grav vehicles benefit from **doubled movement distance**, like wheeled vehicles.

Assaulting

Anti-grav vehicles follow the **standard assault rules for vehicles**. If the vehicle is **fully enclosed**, it is treated as a **tank** for assault resolution.

Other Rules

Other than the above rules, anti-grav vehicles use the standard vehicle rules.

Damage Value Chart

Troops and Soft-Skinned Targets

Result N.	Target Type
3+	Inexperienced infantry or artillery
4+	Regular infantry or artillery
5+	Veteran infantry or artillery
6+	All soft-skinned vehicles, including Light Aircraft and Scout Walkers

Armored Targets

Result N.	Target Type
7+	Armored car/carrier, Light Walker, Medium Aircraft
8+	Light tank, Medium Walker, Heavy Aircraft
9+	Medium tank, Heavy Walker
10+	Heavy tank, Super-heavy Walker
11+	Super-heavy tank

Weapons Table

Type - SMALL ARMS	Range	Shots	Pen	Special Rules
Pistol/Boltshot	6"	1	-	–
Plasma Pistol/Disruptor	12"	1	-	Overcharge, Overheat
Submachine Gun (SMG)	12"	2	-	Assault
Mangler	12"	1	-	Assault
Needler	6"/12"	2/1	-	Assault, Tracking, Supercombine
Mauler	6"	2	-	Assault
Rifle/Sentinel Beam	24"	1	-	–
Shock Rifle	24"	1	-	Overcharge
Shotgun/Heatwave/Scattershot	18"	1	-	Assault
Assault Rifle/Suppressor	18"	2	-	Assault
Spike Rifle	18"	2	-	Assault, Cover Negation
Plasma Rifle	18"	2	-	Overheat, Assault
Battle Rifle/Covenant Carbine	24"/30"	2/1	-	–
Pulse Carbine	24"/30"	2/1	-	Overheat, Tracking
DMR/Stalker Rifle/Light Rifle	30"	1	-	Range Finder
Needle Rifle	30"	1	-	Supercombine, Range Finder
Automatic Rifle	30"	2	-	–
Sniper Rifle/Binary Rifle	36"	1	-	Sniper, Team
Beam Rifle	36"	1	-	Sniper, Team, Overheat
Plasma Repeater (LMG)	36"	4	-	Overheat, MG
Light Machine Gun (LMG)	36"	4	-	–
Medium Plasma MG (MMG)	36"	6	-	Team, Fixed, MG, Overheat
Medium Machine Gun (MMG)	36"	6	-	Team, Fixed

Type - HEAVY WEAPONS	Range	Shots	Pen	Special Rules
Heavy Machine Gun (HMG)	48"	6	+1	Team, Fixed
Heavy Plasma MG (HMG)	48"	6	+1	Team, Fixed, MG, Overheat
Anti-Tank Rifle/Skewer	48"	1	+2	–
Spartan Laser	30"	1	+7	Team, Battery Charge, Shaped Charge
Rocket/Plasma Launcher	30"	1	+5	Team, Shaped Charge, Tracking, HE (1")
Fuel Rod Gun	30"	1	+4	Team, Shaped Charge, HE (2")
Incineration Cannon	30"	1	+4	Team, Shaped Charge, Overheat, HE (1")
Assault Cannon	36"	1	+2	Overheat, Shaped Charge, HE (2")
Light Automatic Cannon	48"	2	+2	Team, Fixed, HE (1")
Light Plasma Cannon	48"	2	+2	Overheat, Team, Fixed, HE (1")
Heavy Automatic Cannon	72"	2	+3	Team, Fixed, HE (1")
Fuel Rod Autocannon	72"	2	+3	Team, Fixed, Tracking, HE (1")
Light Anti-Tank Weapon	48"	1	+4	Team, Fixed, HE (1"), AT Gun
Medium Anti-Tank Weapon	60"	1	+5	Team, Fixed, HE (1"), AT Gun
Heavy Anti-Tank Weapon	72"	1	+6	Team, Fixed, HE (2"), AT Gun
Super-Heavy Anti-Tank Weap.	84"	1	+7	Team, Fixed, HE (3"), AT Gun
Flamethrower (Infantry)	6"	1	+2	Team, Flamethrower
Flamethrower (Vehicle)	12"	1	+2	Flamethrower
Ravager	12"	1	+2	Team, Flamethrower
Grenade Launcher/Brute Shot	30" (12–36")	1	HE	Howitzer, HE (1")
Concussion Rifle/Cindershot	30" (12–36")	1	HE	Knockback, Howitzer, HE (1")
Light Howitzer	48" (30–60")	1	HE	Team, Fixed, Howitzer, HE (2")
Medium Howitzer	60" (36–72")	1	HE	Team, Fixed, Howitzer, HE (3")
Heavy Howitzer	72" (42–84")	1	HE	Team, Fixed, Howitzer, HE (4")

Weapon Special Rules

The following special rules are used to represent the different types of weapons, as indicated on the Weapons Table.

Assault

Weapons with the Assault rule suffer **no penalty to hit when moving and shooting**. Additionally, infantry models armed with an Assault weapon count as having the **Tough Fighters** special rule, allowing them to re-roll failed rolls in close combat.

Battery Charge

Weapons with this rule require to charge up powerful energy attacks. As a result, they suffer a **-1 to hit** modifier when shooting.

Cover Negation

When this weapon hits an Infantry or Artillery unit that is in **soft cover** and not **Down**, any **natural 6** rolled to **wound** worsens the target's **cover save** by one step, for that wound only.

Fixed

Fixed weapons can only fire within a 45-degree arc. A **Run order** must be used to reposition them.

Flamethrower

Flamethrowers automatically hit units inside buildings or fortifications and cause D6 hits per attack. Each hit inflicts an additional +1 Pin Marker in addition to damage. Flamethrowers always strike the top armor of vehicles, ignoring the -1 penetration modifier for long range and the +1 penetration bonus for point-blank range. Units hit by a flamethrower must make an immediate morale check, with failure resulting in the unit being destroyed.

HE (High Explosive)

Weapons with the HE rule can fire explosive rounds that deal area damage using templates (ranging from 1" to 4"). Units under the template take damage, and multiple hits may be inflicted. HE weapons also cause pin markers proportional to the template size.

Howitzer

Howitzers are versatile artillery pieces capable of both direct and indirect fire. When firing over open sights for direct fire, howitzers have no minimum range and operate like any weapon with a direct line of sight. However, when firing indirectly, howitzers follow the rules for **Indirect Fire** and have a minimum range as noted on the Weapons Table (e.g., 30"–60" for light howitzers). Switching between direct fire and indirect fire resets the zeroing-in process for indirect fire, even if the same target is aimed at.

Indirect Fire

Shots fired indirectly start with a 6 to hit, improving with successive turns against the same target. Indirect fire weapons typically have a minimum range, and they hit vehicles on the top armor if successful. Moving or switching spotters resets the zero in.

Knockback

After an ungarrisoned infantry unit takes at least one hit, roll a D6. On a **4+**, the unit must immediately move **3"** directly away from the firer and gains **1 pin**. If this movement would cause the unit to enter impassable terrain, a

building, or another unit, it stops 1" before contact instead.

MG

Weapons with the *MG* rule are treated as machine guns for all gameplay purposes. This includes interactions such as halved shots when mounted on vehicles and any rules or effects that specifically reference machine guns.

Overcharge

When a weapon with this rule shoots, declare that the weapon is overcharging. If so, shots ignore the target's **Energy Shields rule** and can **pin vehicles up to armor 9+**, even if they do not have the open-topped rule. However, overcharging applies a **-1 to hit** modifier.

Overheat

Before shooting, choose which weapons in the unit are **overheated**. Each overheated weapon gains **+1 shot** for this attack. **After resolving all shooting**, place **1 pin marker on the firing unit for each weapon that was overheated**. Weapons do not have to be overheated simultaneously, you may mix overheated and normal fire, even with the same weapon type.

Paired

Paired **machineguns** do not halve their shoots.

Range Finder

Weapons with the *Range Finder* rule are optimized for long-distance engagements and fare poorly at close range. As a result, if the target is within **6** inches, the shooter suffers a **-1 to hit** penalty (reducing the usual point-blank bonus to **+1 instead of +2**).

Sniper

Units equipped with this weapon count as having the **Sniper** special rule.

Supercombine

Weapons with the Supercombine rule cause chain reactions when hitting vital points. When rolling to hit, each **natural roll of 6** allows you to roll **one additional die to wound** against the same target. Even if the weapon uses HE.

Team

Weapons with the Team rule require at least two models to operate effectively. If only one operator remains, the weapon suffers a **-1 to hit** modifier due to the increased workload.

Tracking

Weapons with the Tracking rule are highly advanced and accurate. When issuing a **FIRE** order, ignore the **-1 to hit** penalty caused by the unit being pinned. All other modifiers apply as normal.

Unit Special Rules

The following unit special rules apply to various units as described in the army lists and scenarios. These rules represent specific skills, abilities, or unique characteristics of particular unit types.

Automaton

Automatons possess basic decision-making capabilities but lack the quick reactions and judgment of human soldiers. Units with this rule cannot be issued **Ambush** orders and are not affected by **Horror's -1 morale**. Automatons cannot benefit from **medics** or the **YOU MEN, SNAP TO ACTION!** rule.

Behind Enemy Lines

Units with the Behind Enemy Lines special rule are highly trained in infiltration and surprise tactics. When entering the battlefield using **Reserves** or the **Outflank** deployment, these units **ignore** the **-1** modifier to the order test for coming onto the table.

Berserker

When performing an assault, models in the unit count as having **1 extra attack in close combat**. Additionally, If a Berserker unit **fails an Order test (excluding FUBAR)** and there is an **enemy Infantry or Artillery unit within assault reach** (i.e., eligible to be assaulted under the core rules), it **must** immediately take a **Run (Assault)** order against the **nearest eligible** unit. If **no** such unit is within assault reach, resolve the failed test **as normal** (the unit goes **Down**).

Composed Beings

Prometheans and other advanced AI mechanical constructs, often the result of biological entities being transformed into machines, exhibit unwavering focus and resilience on the battlefield. These units are not affected by **Horror's -1 morale** and cannot benefit from **medics**.

Engineers

When an Engineer unit assaults a building, the **defenders do not benefit from the defensive position bonus**.

Energy Shield

Units equipped with advanced energy shielding gain additional protection in battle. When targeted by shooting attacks, units with this rule **increase their "to wound" difficulty by +1** (e.g., a weapon that would normally wound on a 4+ now wounds on a 5+). In addition, units with this rule have a **5+ cover save in the open and add +1 to their other cover saves**.

Fanatics

Fanatics refuse to retreat or surrender, choosing instead to fight to the bitter end. **They ignore negative morale modifiers from pin markers when taking morale checks**. Fanatics are not automatically routed when their pin markers equal or exceed their morale value. In close quarters, if a Fanatic infantry/artillery unit is defeated, the fight is treated as a draw, and another round of combat is immediately fought. This continues until the Fanatics either win or are wiped out.

Fast

Units with the Fast rule have a base movement of **8 inches**, allowing them to **Run** up to **16 inches**.

Fieldcraft

Units with **Fieldcraft** treat **rough terrain as open ground** for movement. When they **assault a unit through rough ground**, the **defender loses Defensive Position**.

Flight

These units can **Advance** up to **12 inches** and **Run** up to **18 inches**, ignoring terrain restrictions during their movement. However, they cannot **end** their **move** in **impassable** terrain, nor in **rough ground** if a **run** order was issued instead. If a unit with the Flight rule is ambushed or fired upon while flying, it cannot benefit from soft/hard cover saves. Infantry units with this rule may opt to move on the ground instead, following the standard movement rules for infantry. **Units that use Flight cannot pick up or carry objectives on a Run order**.

Flood Infection

When a unit with this rule defeats an enemy Infantry or Artillery unit in an assault, roll one **D6** for each **enemy model removed** during and after that combat. For each roll equal to or greater than the **damage value** of the Flood unit, one slain model may be immediately returned to the unit, up to its original starting size. If the unit has Energy Shields, increase its damage value by 1 for the purposes of this rule. This ability has no effect against **Automatons** and **Composed Beings**, who are immune due to their non-organic nature.

Green

Green units represent inexperienced troops who are unpredictable on the battlefield. These units are rated as Inexperienced with a morale value of 8.

The first time a Green unit takes a casualty, roll a D6 (after resolving any morale checks from the attack):

- **1:** The unit gains additional D6 pin markers and goes Down.
- **2–5:** The unit continues as normal with no additional effects.
- **6:** The unit is upgraded to Regular with a morale value of 9 for the rest of the battle.

Horror

When a unit is **assaulted** by a **Horror unit**, it suffers a **-1 morale** penalty and must immediately take a **morale check**. If the check fails, the unit goes **Down** and cannot perform any reactions. Units with the Horror rule themselves are **immune** to this rule.

Infiltrator

These units gain an additional **+1 to their cover saves** if they have no Advance or Run order dice on them. Infiltrators may also benefit from special deployment rules.

Large Infantry

Some models are significantly larger than standard soldiers. Units with the Large Infantry rule count as **double** when calculating transport capacity. Additionally, in close quarters the **opponent never gains Defensive Position**.

Resilient

This rule replaces Energy Shields and Shield Wall. Units with the **Resilient** rule are exceptionally tough. They have a **damage value** of **6+,** a **5+ cover save in the open or in Close Quarters** and **add +2 to their other cover saves.**

Shield Wall

When a unit with the Shield Wall rule is in open ground, it benefits from a **base 6+ cover save**. If the unit goes **Down** in the open, this save **improves by +2**, becoming a **4+** cover save. When the unit is in cover, Shield Wall **improves the cover save by one step**—soft cover provides a **4+** save (instead of 5+), and hard cover provides a **3+** save (instead of 4+). If the unit is both in cover and Down, apply the usual +2 cover save. Rolls of 1 always fail, regardless of modifiers.

Shirkers

Shirkers are unwilling or unmotivated soldiers who perform poorly under pressure. For all morale checks, order tests, and routing calculations, **pin markers count as double** for units with this rule (e.g., 1 pin marker counts as -2, 2 pin markers count as -4, etc.). Additionally, Shirkers must **always take an order test** when issued an order, even if they are not pinned.

Sniper

While at full strength (2 models), one friendly Regular or Veteran Indirect Fire unit (including Howitzers) may draw line of sight from this team as if the team were its **Spotter**. If the sniper is killed, the remaining model may fire the sniper rifle at **–1** to hit, and the unit suffers the usual **–1** Morale for losing its leader. When the sniper is not using the scope, both models may fire their personal weapons and fully participate in assaults. When firing on a Fire or Ambush order, you may declare a scope shot, if the target is within **12**", the shot automatically misses; otherwise the shot is **+1** to hit, ignores **cover**, and is **+1** to damage against Infantry or Artillery units, and if it causes damage you may choose the unit leader as the casualty.

Slow

Units with the Slow rule have reduced mobility compared to standard infantry. Their base movement is limited to **4** inches, and they can Run up to **8** inches.

Stealth

While a unit with the **Stealth** rule has a **Down** order, ranged attacks targeting it suffer an additional **-1 to hit** modifier.

Strikes First

The unit counts as having **Defensive Position** bonus when performing assaults, causing it to **fight first**. If the opponent also has Defensive Position, Strikes First or a rule cancels this rule, then **fight simultaneously**.

Strong

This unit **ignores** the **Team Weapon** and **Fixed** special rules for weapons it carries. In addition, for **every three models** in your unit involved in close quarters you may **add an additional die when rolling to damage for one chosen model**.

Stubborn

If forced to take a morale check, they **ignore negative morale modifiers from pin markers**. Remember that order tests are not morale checks, and are therefore modified as normal.

Tank Hunters

If a tank hunter unit wins an assault and scores damage against a vehicle, the effect is resolved on the Damage Results Table rather than the Superficial Damage Table. In addition, these troops don't suffer from the **Tank Fear** rule when assaulting fully enclosed armoured vehicles, and their rolls to damage vehicles have a **+1**.

Tooth and Claw

Models with the Tooth and Claw special rule excel in hand-to-hand combat, rolling **three base attack** dice instead of one in close quarters.

Tough Fighters

Units with the Tough Fighters rule are skilled in close combat. When attacks from a model with this rule fail to hit/inflict damage during close quarters combat against infantry, artillery or assault walkers it may re-roll failed melee rolls.

VISR

Units equipped with the **Visual Intelligence System, Reconnaissance** system have advanced sensors and targeting capabilities. Units with the **VISR** special rule can see through smoke, treating it as if it were not present when determining line of sight. Additionally, when targeting a unit with the **Stealth** rule, ignore the **-1 to hit** modifier from the Stealth rule.

Wide Formation

Models in a unit with this rule may keep up to **2" coherency between models instead of 1"**, reducing vulnerability to blasts while maintaining mutual support.

Vehicle Special Rules

The following special rules apply to various vehicles, providing unique traits and abilities for gameplay.

Agile

A vehicle with this rule may make an additional 90-degree pivot during its movement and is capable of pivoting **on a Fire order**.

Armoured All Round

Vehicles with this rule have equivalent armor on all sides. No penetration modifiers apply for attacks against the sides, rear, or top—shots count against the full armor value regardless of angle.

Assault

Restricted to walkers. A vehicle with this rule can assault infantry and vehicles using the unique rules for walkers. In addition, while being **Down** they gain a **6+ cover save** in the open or **+1** to their cover save.

Command Vehicle

Vehicles with this rule are equipped with enhanced communication systems that provide a morale bonus of **+1** to themselves and all friendly vehicles within **12**". Additionally, a Command Vehicle can issue one 'You men, snap to action!' order to a **single** friendly **vehicle** within **12**", except other Command Vehicles.

Faster

Vehicles with the Faster rule benefit from enhanced mobility. Fast vehicles can move **12**" with an Advance order and **24**" with a Run order.

Fist

Some walkers are equipped with powerful mechanical fists designed for devastating close-quarters combat. Walkers with this rule gain an **additional attack dice** in close quarters for each fist they possess. This rule only applies in close combat.

Flak

Units with **Flak** automatically fire at aircraft called by **Forward Air Observers** if the aircraft is within their range and arc, as described in the BA third edition rulebook. However, against **on-table aircraft units** (e.g., helicopters and VTOLs), Flak does **not** auto-fire; it simply **ignores the −1 to hit** penalty for targeting flying aircraft. **Pintle-mounted weapons** count as having Flak.

Impulse Drive

At the start of this vehicle's activation, you may declare Impulse Drive. During this activation, when this unit **Advances** or **Runs** it **ignores other models and terrain for movement** (distances unchanged; **no road bonus**), but it **cannot end** its move on **impassable terrain**, **in buildings**, **in rough ground**, or **within 1"** of enemy units (unless assaulting per assault walker rules). Any **Ambush** fire resolved **during this movement** treats the vehicle as **in the open** (**no cover saves**); after it finishes moving, resolve cover **normally** for subsequent attacks.

Nimble

Aircraft with this rule are exceptionally agile. This aircraft's **Evasion save improves by +1 (4+ instead of 5+)**.

Open-Topped

Vehicles with this rule are more vulnerable to attacks and offer less protection to their occupants. They are **pinned by small-arms fire** like soft-skinned vehicles and **automatically destroyed in assaults if damaged**. If hit on the **top armor**, they suffer an additional **+1** to the **damage roll and damage table**.

Recce

Reconnaissance vehicles can perform special **escape reactions** when shot at, **moving** with an Advance or Run order **to avoid damage**. They may also **reverse** at **full** Advance **speed**. Specific rules for their escape reactions apply during shooting and assaults, as detailed in the main rules.

Reinforced Front Armour

Vehicles with this rule count their front armor as **1** higher than their listed value against all shots hitting the front arc.

Slow

Vehicles with this rule are less mobile, moving only **6**" with an Advance order and **12**" with a Run order.

Weak Sides

Vehicles with this rule have vulnerable side armor. Attacks against the sides count as hitting the rear, gaining a **+2** penetration modifier instead of **+1**.

Rules Summary

Vehicle Maneuver Chart

Unit Type	Advance	Pivot (90°) when Advancing	Run	Pivot (90°) when Running
Tracked vehicle	9"	2	18"	1
Half-tracked vehicle	9"	2	18"	1
Wheeled vehicle	12"	2	24"	1
Walkers	9"	2	18"	1
Anti-grav vehicle	9"	4	18"	2
Aircraft	24"	Unlimited	48"	Unlimited

Terrain Effects Chart

Terrain Category	Infantry	Artillery	Wheeled Vehicles	Tracked Vehicles	Walkers	Anti-Grav	Aircraft
Open ground	OK	OK	OK	OK	OK	OK	OK
Rough ground	No Run	No*	No	No Run	OK	No Run	OK/
Obstacle	No Run	No	No	OK*	OK	OK*	OK/
Building	OK	No*	No	No (!)	No (!)	No (!)	OK/
Road	OK	OK	X2	OK	X2	x2	OK

OK*: The unit can cross this kind of terrain without hindrance unless it has been designated as an anti-tank obstacle.

No*: The unit cannot enter or move within this kind of terrain, but it can be deployed within the terrain at the start of the game. In this case, it cannot move once deployed.

No (!): The unit cannot enter or move within this kind of terrain, except that heavy and super-heavy vehicles may move through and demolish some buildings in some situations.

OK/: The unit can move through this type of terrain without hindrance. It may end its movement here, provided it can remain stable and avoid falling. However, Aircraft cannot land in this type of terrain unless players agree to.

Hit Modifiers Chart

4+ BASE

Criteria	Modifier
Fire on the move (Not if Assault)	-1
Firer is pinned (Not if Tracking)	-1
Firer is inexperienced	-1
Point-blank range (Not VS flying Aircraft) and (Range Finder = -1)	+2
FIRE order with AT Gun vs Vehicles (Not vs Flying aircraft)	+1
Target is down and has Stealth (Not if VISR)	-1
Target is a flying aircraft (Not if FLAK)	-1

Vehicle Penetration Modifiers Chart

Criteria	Modifier
Vehicle's side or top armor (Not vs Aircraft/Walkers)	+1
Vehicle's rear armor (Not vs Aircraft/Walkers)	+2
Long Range	-1
Point-blank range (Not vs Flying Aircraft)	+1

Damage Value Chart

Troops and Soft-Skinned Targets

Result N.	Target Type
3+	Inexperienced infantry or artillery
4+	Regular infantry or artillery
5+	Veteran infantry or artillery
6+	All soft-skinned vehicles, including Light Aircraft and Scout Walkers

Armored Targets

Result N.	Target Type
7+	Armored car/carrier, Light Walker, Medium Aircraft
8+	Light tank, Medium Walker, Heavy Aircraft
9+	Medium tank, Heavy Walker
10+	Heavy tank, Super-heavy Walker
11+	Super-heavy tank

SUPERFICIAL DAMAGE RESULTS ON AIRCRAFT

D6	Effect
1, 2, or 3	**Crew Shaken:** Add 1 pin marker and take a morale test. If it fails and the aircraft is flying, the Aircraft must take a Down order and land immediately in the nearest legal position. If it fails and the aircraft is already landed, it cannot perform further actions this turn. Place a Down order die to represent this.
4 or 5	**Engine Damage:** The Aircraft's speed is halved for the remainder of the game. If this result occurs again, add 1 pin marker and take a Down order to land.
6	**System Malfunction:** The Aircraft must land immediately within 9 inches in the nearest legal position. Add 2 pin markers and take a Down order. If already landed, treat this as "On Fire" from the Full Damage Table.

Note: If the Aircraft takes superficial damage and no legal landing position is available, roll on the Full Damage Table instead of the Superficial Damage Table.

FULL DAMAGE RESULTS ON AIRCRAFT TABLE

D6	Effect
1	**Crew Shaken:** Add 1 pin marker. If flying, the Aircraft must take a Down order and land immediately in the nearest legal position. If landed, it cannot perform further actions this turn. Place a Down order die to represent this.
2	**Targeting Failure:** The weapon's targeting system glitches. The affected vehicle suffers a **–1 to hit** penalty on all shooting for the rest of the game. Add 1 pin marker.
3	**On Fire:** Add 2 pin markers. Roll a morale check. If passed, extinguish the fire and take a Down order and land. If failed and the Aircraft is landed, the crew abandons the Aircraft , and it is destroyed. If the Aircraft is flying, treat it like "Destroyed" below.
4, 5 or 6	**Destroyed:** The Aircraft is destroyed and becomes a wreck. If flying, all units within 6 inches horizontally take D3 pin markers from falling debris.

Note: If the Aircraft takes full damage and you get an effect that requires the Aircraft to land while there is no legal landing position available, add +1 to the roll for determining full damage effects.

Vehicle Type Summary

Walkers

Assault Rules

Walkers with the **Assault** rule roll **2 base attacks** plus **+1 per Fist**. Halve attacks to get a +1 PEN. Each attack rolls directly for damage using the following **PEN** value based on the walker's class:

Walker Class	PEN Value
Scout	+1
Light	+2
Medium	+3
Heavy	+4
Super-Heavy	+5

Infantry Assaulting Walkers

- Must roll a **6+ to hit** if the walker has advanced (Can't assault if run), or **4+** if **Down**, **immobilized**, or **unactivated**.
- Each successful hit adds **+1** to a **single damage roll** against the walker's damage value.
- **Assault** walkers roll directly to damage; use the appropriate **PEN** value.
- Assaulting **fully enclosed walkers** requires a **Morale test at –3** (Tank Hunters are exempt).
- If the infantry **causes no damage and takes casualties**, the **entire unit is removed**.
- If neither side causes damage or casualties, the **combat continues**.
- If the walker is damaged and survives, the infantry **may fall back D6"**, even if they took casualties.

Walker vs. Walker

- If both walkers have **Assault**, resolve the fight **simultaneously**.
- If no victor, at the end of each round, each walker suffers **1 pin +1 per Fist** from its opponent.
- Combat continues until one or both are **routed or destroyed**.

Vehicles Assaulting Walkers

- Treated as **standard vehicle rams**.

Assault Walkers Assaulting Vehicles

- Must use a **Run order** to assault.
- Roll **2 + 1 per Fist** direct **damage rolls** against the target's **front armor** (no to-hit roll).
- Add the walker's **PEN value** to each damage roll.

- If target survives, it suffers **1 pin +1 per Fist**, and the walker must **fall back D6**".

Shooting at Walkers

- Walkers are treated as having the **same armor value on all facings**.
- Attacks **do not gain bonuses** for hitting **side, rear, or top armor**.

Aircraft

Aircraft operate in two distinct states: **Flying** and **Landed**, with very different rules.

Flying Aircraft

- Cannot be **assaulted**, and **do not provide or receive cover**.
- Move **24" (Advance)** or **48" (Run)** with **unlimited pivots**.
- Do **not block line of sight**, and do not benefit from or interfere with cover.
- **Ignore intervening terrain and models** for LOS and cover when firing or being fired upon. Unless **tall**, or within **3".**
- When airborne, attacks against them suffer **–1 to hit**, unless the attacker has **Flak**. They also have a **5+ evasion save**.
- **Cannot embark/disembark** units. However, **units with Flight** may disembark.
- Do **not gain or grant Point Blank bonus**. AT guns do not have +1 to hit on a FIRE vs them.

Landed Aircraft

- Land on a **down** order within **9**, until a run or advance order is given.
- May be **assaulted** and benefit from **cover**.
- May **embark/disembark** as normal.
- May only fire **pintle-mounted weapons**, unless otherwise specified.

Shooting at Aircraft

- Treated as having the **same armor value on all facings**.
- Attacks do **not gain bonuses** for hitting **side, rear, or top armor**.
- **Point Blank bonus does not apply** when targeting or being targeted while **Flying**.

Damage Tables

- Use the **Aircraft Damage Table**.
- Aircraft with **Armor 6+** are **destroyed outright** if damaged.
- Special rules apply for **morale**, **fire**, and **crash landing**.

Anti-Grav Vehicles

Anti-grav vehicles hover just above the ground, offering high mobility and flexibility.

Movement

- **Advance**: 9" with up to **4×90° pivots** (or one 360° pivot).
- **Run**: 18" with up to **2×90° pivots** (or one 180° pivot).
- May not **Run through rough terrain** or **enter buildings**.
- May cross **obstacles (unless antitank)**.
- On **roads**, movement is **doubled**.

Assaults

- Follow **standard vehicle assault rules**.
- Fully armored enclosed anti-grav vehicles are treated as **tanks**.

Shooting at Anti-Grav Vehicles

- Follow **standard vehicle targeting rules**.

Other Rules

- Use standard rules for **LOS**, **shooting**, **transport**, and **damage**.

F.A.Q

Q: How do line of sight and cover work when a flying Aircraft shoots at (or is shot by) a ground unit? A: Use this three-step check:

1. Line of sight (LoS)

- **Tall terrain in between?** (e.g., multi-story building, cliff you agreed counts as "**tall**") → **LoS is blocked both ways** unless both models are flying Aircraft.
- **No tall terrain in between?** LoS is **open**. Intervening models/terrain don't block LoS for air↔ground.

2. Cover

- **Ground unit being shot by a flying Aircraft:** The ground unit only gets cover if an intervening **element or unit** is **within 3" of the ground target** and the LoS **crosses** it. (This includes friendly or enemy models near the target.)
- **Flying Aircraft being shot by ground units:** Flying Aircraft **never** receive cover (They still get their 5+ Evasion save as normal.)

3. Optional variant (declare pre-game)

- Before the game, players may agree that certain **non-tall elements within 3" of the target** that the LoS crosses **block LoS (both ways)** rather than merely granting cover—useful for very large and dense hedges or high walls that still don't qualify as "tall."

Q: If a unit is behind both terrain (e.g., a wall) and a friendly Shield Wall unit, what cover bonus does it receive from Wall of Deflection? A: The unit receives a total improvement of +1 to its cover save. For example, if the unit already has hard cover (4+), this is upgraded to a 3+. If the unit goes Down, it is upgraded to a maximum of 2+, as rolls of 1 always fail.

Q: Can Aircraft like the Sparrowhawk negate cover granted by Wall of Deflection? A: Yes. Flying Aircraft ignore the Wall of Deflection if the Shield Wall unit is more than 3" from the target even if the line of fire crosses it. Wall of Deflection also has no effect against indirect fire weapons, flamethrowers, nor snipers.

Q: Does a unit gain the Desperate Measures bonus every time it is reduced to half strength? A: No. A unit only gains the Desperate Measures bonus once, the first time it is reduced to half or fewer of its starting models (rounding up).

Q: Does the "Cannon Fodder" free Grunt Squad count towards the normal platoon infantry limits? A: No, it does not count towards the limit; it is an additional free squad.

Q: Does Spartan Leadership allow re-rolls of order tests as well as morale checks? A: No, Spartan Leadership specifically allows re-rolls of morale checks only, not order tests.

Q: Can a flying Aircraft that is landing with a Down order be Ambushed? A: Yes. Landing is considered movement, so if a flying Aircraft lands within 9" of its previous position and crosses the line of sight and firing arc of a unit in Ambush, the Ambush may be triggered as normal.

Q: Does a flying Aircraft still count as airborne (and suffer the -1 to be hit) when ambushed and landing with a Down order? A**:** Yes. A flying Aircraft remains airborne and retains its -1 to be hit modifier until it completes the Down order and physically lands. Therefore, if Ambushed during the landing move, the -1 to be hit still applies.

Q: Does a flying Aircraft receive cover when Ambushed while landing? A**:** No. Flying Aircraft do not benefit from cover while airborne, including during a landing move. However, they still benefit from their 5+ Evasion save against any hits taken while landing, as they are considered airborne until the Down order is completed.

Q: If I have a unit with multiple Plasma Rifles, can I choose to Overheat only some of them? A: Yes. Weapons with the Overheat rule may be overheated individually, even if multiple models in the unit have the same weapon. You may choose to Overheat some, all, or none of the Plasma Rifles when firing. Overheat is declared per weapon before rolling to hit, and only those weapons that are overheated will gain the extra shot and the Pin marker.

Q: Can flying Aircraft capture or contest objectives? A: No. Flying Aircraft cannot capture or contest objectives while airborne. They must perform a Down order and physically land to interact with objective points.

Q: Can Biomass Markers be harvested by units that are Down from a failed order? A: No. Units must voluntarily issue a Down order to harvest; being Down from failing an order does not allow harvesting.

Q: If an Infection Form carrying a Biomass Marker is destroyed, what happens to the marker? A: The marker moves with the unit as if it were another model in the unit. If the entire unit is destroyed, leave the marker in place at its current position.

Q: Can an enemy unit surrounding a Biomass Marker prevent it from being harvested? A: Yes. If enemy models physically prevent a Flood unit from legally ending movement within 3" of the marker (e.g., due to the 1" proximity rule), the marker cannot be harvested until the blocking unit moves or is destroyed.

Q: After *Assimilate* turns an Infection Form unit into an (unarmed) Combat Form unit, how many models can it later recover via Flood Infection or Biomass Remnants? A: Use the Infection Form unit's *original starting size* (the number of models it had when it first deployed) as the cap. The converted Combat Form unit can replenish back up to that number, but never exceed it.

Q: Does Knockback (or any forced movement) make an indirect-fire weapon lose its ranging-in? A: Yes. If the target or firer unit moves for any reason before the next indirect shot, start again at 6+.

Q: Do spotters benefit from the special rules and doctrine bonuses of their parent unit? A: Yes, spotters inherit the unit-wide special rules and doctrine effects of their team (e.g., *Stealth, Fieldcraft, Stubborn, Fanatics, Energy Shields, VISR*). They do not gain rules that require using weapons/crew actions (e.g., *Team Weapon, Fixed, Loader bonuses, Overheat, Flamethrower traits*), and they still can't shoot, assault, or capture objectives.

Q: If a Forerunner unit teleports using Teleportation Network or Phase Step, can it score in missions where a unit must reach a table edge to exit and score? A: No. Teleportation Network and Phase Step do not allow a unit to move off the battlefield or "exit" via a table edge. Teleport moves must end on the battlefield, so they cannot be used to score objectives that require leaving the battlefield.

Q: For Enhanced Weapon Systems, does a natural 6 always trigger the +1 Penetration, even if there are negative to-hit modifiers? A: No. The trigger is a final modified hit roll of 6+, not an unmodified natural 6. Apply all to-hit modifiers first; if the result is 6 or higher, that shot gains +1 Penetration. For example, with -1 to hit, an unmodified 6 becomes a 5 and does not trigger this rule. With +2 to hit (e.g., point blank), an unmodified 4 becomes a 6 and does trigger this rule.